

A YEAR IN OVERVIEW
ANNUAL REPORT

APRIL 2024- MARCH 2025

KHULISA
SOCIAL SOLUTIONS
Reinventing lives

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MESSAGE

FROM THE CHAIRPERSON

IAN MANN

"We are also proud of Khulisa's growing role as a thought leader in social cohesion."

As Chairperson of Khulisa Social Solutions, I am proud to reflect on a year that tested the limits of the NGO sector and reaffirmed our shared purpose. Amid economic strain, shifting donor priorities, and growing social fragmentation, Khulisa stood firm in its mission to build bridges of trust and drive systemic change in South Africa's most vulnerable communities.

The Board took an active role in navigating these complexities, including delays in DSD funding and a major transition in banking services. We responded by strengthening our ethical governance structures, establishing two new committees—Social Strategy and Ethics, and Audit and Risk—in alignment with King IV principles. These developments have positioned us well for enhanced compliance, transparency, and strategic foresight.

Based on a comprehensive Board Self-Assessment, we are enhancing our diversity and skills, particularly in digital innovation, fundraising, and ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance). This enables Khulisa to succeed in an increasingly complex operational environment.

Khulisa's expanding strategic partnerships highlight our commitment to collaborative models that promote long-term sustainability. Our increasing engagement with community trusts has enabled us to broaden our presence into new provinces, greatly enhancing our reach and deepening our impact at the grassroots level.

"we are deeply convinced of the power of Khulisa's approach to social cohesion, grounded in dialogue, systems thinking, and community empowerment."

We are also proud of Khulisa's growing role as a thought leader in social cohesion. This was affirmed by the international recognition of our founder and Managing Director, Lesley Ann van Selm, who was awarded a professional doctorate by the International University of Europe – Paris. This prestigious honour acknowledges her relentless work spanning over 40 years in transforming the lives of those affected by violence, trauma, poverty, and exclusion.



As a Board, we are deeply convinced of the power of Khulisa's approach to social cohesion, grounded in dialogue, systems thinking, and community empowerment. We believe that this model has the potential to unearth the systemic blockages that continue to impede South Africa's progress. It offers a roadmap for healing fractured communities, restoring trust, and creating conditions for inclusive growth.

Looking ahead, the Board remains committed to supporting Khulisa's priorities—restorative justice, digital innovation, and the development of scalable NGO capacity-building models. These efforts are vital to achieving meaningful and measurable impact.

On behalf of the Board, I would like to extend our deepest appreciation to the staff, volunteers, donors, and partners who bring Khulisa's vision to life. Your commitment fuels our hope and propels our mission forward.



MESSAGE

FOUNDER & MANAGING DIRECTOR

LESLEY ANN VAN SELM

REFLECTIONS ON THE YEAR

Over the past year, Khulisa has demonstrated remarkable resilience in navigating a complex and often unpredictable environment. Despite challenges such as Department of Social Development contracting delays and increased competition for private sector support, our values of empathy, innovation, and community-centredness remained our compass. These principles ensured that we continued to serve communities with integrity and impact, even as our systems were tested by internal and external pressures.

One example was a series of cyber incidents, which prompted swift action: the appointment of a full-time cybersecurity specialist, the rollout of multifactor authentication, and an organisation-wide strengthening of digital safeguards. These measures protected our data and, more importantly, preserved the trust of those who rely on us. At the same time, Khulisa's profile has grown on both national and international stages, with contributions to the LifeSphere Trauma Conference and preparations for the G20 Social Cohesion Seminar affirming our role as a systems-change actor that bridges grassroots realities with global dialogue.

DRIVING CHANGE THROUGH OUR ECOSYSTEM APPROACH

Our work continues to be guided by an evolving ecosystem model, which combines community-led needs assessments and asset mapping, dialogue-based healing and restoration, NGO capacitation, AI-assisted monitoring and evaluation, and scalable multi-stakeholder collaboration. This approach enables us to support individuals, strengthen organisations, and reshape systems—proving that transformation happens at the intersection of data, dialogue, and dignity.

This year we expanded into Limpopo and the Northern Cape, while also building coalitions with more than 60 NGOs nationwide. These organisations were capacitated through compliance training, mentorship, and digital connectivity, positioning them as anchors of community change.

"Equity and inclusion remain at the heart of our efforts."



At the same time, our new NGO Consulting Division began addressing systemic blockages by offering payroll, tax, and governance services, while AI-powered M&E innovations such as digital journals and automated dashboards were piloted to strengthen learning and accountability.

Our internal growth was equally significant. We welcomed new staff in M&E and IT, introduced a supervisor feedback system to enhance staff engagement, and revised recruitment and membership policies to improve governance and accountability. We also deepened strategic partnerships with Knowledge Pele, The Peace Humansrus Trust, Sibanye Rustenburg Mine Community Development Trust, De Beers, and DSD—alliances that will sustain and scale our impact.

LOOKING AHEAD WITH INTEGRITY

As we prepare for 2025/2026, our focus will be on deepening our presence in mining and peri-urban communities, scaling accredited NGO training pathways, embedding AI-driven monitoring tools into national programmes, expanding enterprise pathways for women and youth, and reinforcing coalition governance with transparent accountability.

Equity and inclusion remain at the heart of these efforts. Our work this year advanced gender equality through GBV dialogue circles and family reunification, created safe-space programming for LGBTQIA+ communities, and introduced disability-inclusive planning into training for NGOs in Limpopo. These contributions align with the Sustainable Development Goals on health, gender equality, reduced inequalities, strong institutions, and partnerships for development.

FINAL WORD

To our staff, NGO partners, donors, interns, and volunteers—thank you. Your courage, creativity, and compassion remain the heartbeat of Khulisa. Together, we continue to restore dignity, strengthen communities, and catalyse systemic transformation through data, dialogue, and collective action.





KHULISA'S VISION & MISSION

Build cohesive communities

Vision

A safer, healthier and more prosperous South Africa, where all people, especially youth, have access to the information, skills and opportunities they need to contribute to equitable local and national development.

Catalysng social change through an ecosystem approach

Mission

To address social vulnerabilities and inequalities by providing support and developmental know-how, through key partnerships, for initiatives at a community level that quantifiably demonstrate social impact.

OUR PROGRAMMES

GBV PREVENTION AND RESPONSE

Our GBV programmes are structured to provide both preventative and responsive support.

- Engaging men and boys in dialogue circles to unlearn harmful behaviours,
- Offering psychosocial support and economic empowerment opportunities for survivors of GBV.

COMMUNITY EDUCATION & ADVOCACY

We facilitate comprehensive community education and advocacy programmes aimed at increasing awareness of human rights, reducing stigma associated with GBV, and promoting gender equality.

- Targeted door-to-door campaigns,
- Dialogue circles, and public advocacy events designed to reach a broad audience and stimulate community-wide dialogue.

DIVERSION & RESTORATIVE JUSTICE PROGRAMS

Our diversion programmes provide alternative pathways for at-risk youth and young offenders to rebuild their lives outside of the criminal justice system.

Through restorative justice practices, we promote reconciliation, accountability, and the reintegration of individuals back into society.

ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

We work with local NGOs and community members to develop skills training and economic empowerment programs.

Khulisa's initiatives focus on creating sustainable livelihoods, with an emphasis on long-term income generation opportunities for marginalized groups.

YOUTH DEVELOPMENT & SCHOOL-BASED PROGRAMS

Khulisa implements a range of school-based initiatives that include life skills development, anti-bullying campaigns, and mentorship programs.

Our interventions are designed to empower young people, foster resilience, and reduce the risk of school dropout and delinquency.

NGO CAPACITY BUILDING

Building the capacity of local NGOs is essential for the sustainability of community interventions.

Khulisa provides tailored training and support to local organizations, enhancing their ability to deliver services, comply with legal requirements, and secure funding.

STRATEGIC PRIORITIES

A REVIEW OF KHULISA'S GOALS FOR THE NEXT YEAR

Deepen the NGO Ecosystem Model

Strengthen interconnected NGOs that share learning, pool resources, and co-design solutions—anchoring communities against unemployment, violence, and exclusion.

Strengthen CIM and Multi-Sector Coalitions

Expand coalitions across government, corporates, civil society, and communities to dismantle silos, share accountability, and deliver coordinated solutions to GBV, poverty, and substance abuse.

Scale Dialogue Circles, SIT and Narrative Therapy

Grow dialogue platforms, combining **SIT (Systematic Inventive Thinking) — a structured method that sparks innovation by working with existing resources** — and narrative therapy to heal trauma, drive reconciliation, and turn communities into cohesive, opportunity-rich ecosystems.

Expand AI-Driven M&E & Feedback Loops

Roll out real-time, AI-powered monitoring that amplifies community voices, tracks emerging needs, and turns data into actionable insights for policy and reform.

Advance Tech-Enabled Impact Measurement

Use mobile data, mapping, and dashboards to capture long-term systemic change, close gaps, and strengthen accountability to donors and communities.

Embed Social Cohesion Everywhere

Make social cohesion the golden thread—ensuring every action builds trust, restores dignity, and creates inclusive opportunities.

TRANSFORMING
SOUTH AFRICA'S SOCIAL LANDSCAPE

KHULISA SOCIAL SOLUTIONS:
A CATALYST FOR SYSTEMIC CHANGE

DRIVING SOCIAL COHESION, CAPACITY BUILDING, AND CROSS-SECTOR COLLABORATION TO CREATE SUSTAINABLE IMPACT.

KHULISA'S THEORY OF CHANGE MODEL

ECO-SYSTEMIC IMPACT
Whole-community approach

TACKLING ROOT CAUSES
Breaking cycles of harm

MULTI-STAKEHOLDER COLLABORATION
Aligning government, business & NGOs

SOCIAL COHESION
Trust-building & mediation

NGO CAPACITY BUILDING
Strengthening grassroots leadership

DATA-DRIVEN RESULTS
Evidence-based interventions

IMPACT

Reduced crime & social violence

Stronger communities & local NGOs

Scalable, sustainable solutions



JOIN US IN RESHAPING SOUTH AFRICA'S FUTURE THROUGH COLLABORATION AND INNOVATION

SPOTLIGHT STORIES OF THE YEAR

KHULISA'S REGIONAL OFFICES WERE REQUESTED TO SUBMIT A SHORT STORY OR CASE STUDY HIGHLIGHTING THEIR MOST IMPACTFUL ACHIEVEMENT OVER THE PAST YEAR.

BELOW ARE THE THREE MOST IMPACTFUL STORIES.

STREETSCAPES: THE STORY OF ELTON: GETTING BACK ON HIS FEET

Elton was arrested for possession of drugs and referred by the court to Khulisa's social workers for intervention. After assessment, he was placed in an appropriate diversion programme.

He attended a one-day substance use session in a group setting. Upon completion, a report was submitted to the court on his behalf, which resulted in the withdrawal of the case and the clearing of his name. During the process, he disclosed challenges of unemployment and homelessness to the social worker and asked for further assistance. Despite these hardships, he expressed strong motivation and eagerness to rebuild his life.

Following the intervention, he maintained contact with Khulisa, believing the organisation could help him get back on his feet. With funds raised to cover the cost of obtaining an ID, the social workers supported him in compiling a CV with assistance from the regional administrator. This was followed by opening a bank account and applying for employment.



Within a space of weeks, the City of Cape Town reached out to Khulisa Social workers with a job offer for the client.

Taking a closer look at the vision and mission of Khulisa Social Solutions, which stipulates the need to create a safer and better South Africa, especially for vulnerable individuals like the client above, this story illustrates just how far social workers are willing to go in ensuring that goal is achieved. Clients are motivated and remain hopeful when they are provided with more than psychosocial support because at the end of the day, behaviour modification is the overall goal. This can be achieved by the client's full acceptance.

Elton says: "Khulisa Staff members changed my life forever, Dankie."

"Khulisa Staff members changed my life forever, Dankie"

WESTERN CAPE: THE STORY OF CLINTON

Still waters run deep - The unassuming and calm energy that Clinton brings to workshops seem to be a confirmation of this popular saying.

An engaged listener, he is also forthright in telling his own story.

"I, Clinton Hendricks, was homeless for 20 years, sleeping in different places in Cape Town and joining different gangs. I abused my soul with different types of drugs. I always ran into problems with security officials and the police. I went around looking for food in white people's trash. And I robbed foreign tourists who came to Cape Town on holiday. All just so that I could support my drug habit and survive through the night."

Clinton shares that the first time he went to prison was because of drugs. After that, he continued to go in and out of the prison system, eventually joining a prison gang and becoming a "Number 28". Number 28s are a part of South Africa's Numbers prison gangs. Members are said to move up in the ranks through violence with rival gangs, prison guards or other members.

"This made my behaviour worse," Clinton admits. "And it took years from my life."

Once out of prison, Clinton found his way to Streetscapes, aware that he had lost touch with reality.

"Streetscapes taught me how to talk in the right manner and this helped me become independent and more confident," he notes. He adds that seeing his social worker every week helped to keep him accountable.

Today, Clinton is an assistant supervisor for Streetscapes and has his own team that he heads. He is also a peer field worker.

"Field work is very good because now, I can help others," he says. "I can help with reuniting people with their families or going to rehabilitation centres or day hospitals to check on health issues."



"Streetscapes taught me how to talk in the right manner and this helped me become independent and more confident"



GAUTENG: HOPE REBORN – A TEEN MOM'S FRESH START THROUGH DIVERSION

A 16-year-old girl, also a young mother, was referred for diversion by a Westrand court after being charged with shoplifting. The stolen items—maize meal, milk, meat, cheese, and school lunch items—were not luxuries but basic food she needed for herself and her three-month-old baby. With no family support and strained relationships that forced her to live independently, desperation rather than delinquency drove her actions.

Khulisa Social Solutions enrolled her in a structured diversion programme. There, she attended life skills sessions focusing on cognitive, social, and daily living skills, as well as psychoeducation and therapeutic activities. Creative tools such as the "mask" and "tree" exercises helped her reflect on destructive behaviours, heal emotional wounds, and identify personal strengths to overcome challenges. She also gained insight into the breakdown of family relationships and learned healthier communication skills.

Family-based interventions were equally vital. A dialogue session with her aunt reopened lines of communication, while her paternal grandmother stepped in to help with caregiving. This restored support network prevented institutional placement and reduced her vulnerability. The school also played a critical role, supporting her return to studies and awarding her a bursary in recognition of her academic ability.

The young mother reports that she no longer feels compelled to "people-please," communicates more effectively, and is regaining her sense of belonging. With safe accommodation, restored family ties, and a committed support system, her school attendance and academic performance have shown significant improvement.

Key partners — the Department of Justice, probation officer, school, family members, and Khulisa's social worker — collaborated closely to ensure success. Reintegration and aftercare services will be provided for a year to bolster her resilience and lower the risk of reoffending.

Her words capture the impact: "Shame gave me a second chance and the opportunity to rebuild myself and my relationship with my aunt."

"Shame gave me a second chance and the opportunity to rebuild myself and my relationship with my aunt."

BREAKING BREAD TOGETHER

SSC (SHARED SERVICES CENTRE): A PARTNERSHIP OF NOURISHMENT AND HOPE

Across cultures, sharing bread has always meant more than just eating — it's about belonging and building community. In South Africa, where many families face hunger and inequality, this simple act can restore dignity and hope. For Khulisa Social Solutions, food is not only nourishment but also a way to build trust, strengthen relationships, and create space for dialogue.

This spirit defines Khulisa's partnership with The Pantry in Rosebank. When The Pantry opened in 2022, its bakers immediately offered fresh bread to Khulisa before serving their first customers. That small, generous act began a partnership that has now lasted three years.

What makes this special is the quality and consistency of The Pantry's giving. Every week, loaves, pastries, and fresh produce reach families, community events, and Khulisa partners nationwide. These are not leftovers but the same artisanal goods sold to customers — showing that the people Khulisa serves deserve the best.

PANTRY.

Sharing bread means more than filling stomachs. It brings comfort, turns gatherings into celebrations, and reminds people they are valued. It also shows how business and social organisations can achieve more together: The Pantry provides the goods, and Khulisa ensures they reach those in need.

As this partnership enters its third year, it proves that real change often starts with simple, steady acts of kindness. Breaking bread has become a symbol of hope, dignity, and shared humanity.







"Sharing bread means more than filling stomachs. It brings comfort, turns gatherings into celebrations, and reminds people they are valued."

CASE STUDIES OF PARTNER NGOS

FROM SEEDS OF SUPPORT TO THRIVING NGOS

Khulisa Social Solutions has always believed that real change begins with people. By walking alongside individuals for well over a decade, and equipping them with the tools for leadership, Khulisa has seen the birth of organisations that now stand independently as catalysts for transformation.

Three such journeys—those of Peter Kapaso, Lydia Sono, and Lesego Tshabalala —show how mentorship, courage, and community vision can grow into lasting legacies.

PETER KAPASO: IN-TOUCH YOUTH DEVELOPMENT AND COMMUNITY JUSTICE



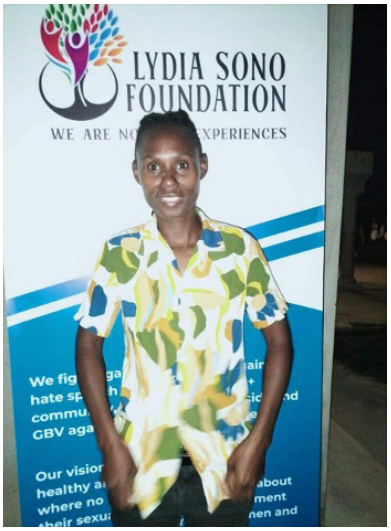
Peter first encountered Khulisa through its restorative justice programmes, where he discovered his gift for mediation and conflict resolution. Trained and mentored in facilitation, he became committed to addressing root causes of violence, poverty, and marginalisation.

Out of this passion, he founded In-Touch Youth Development and Community Justice, formally registered in 2016. Based in Orange Farm, Heidelberg, and Mokopane, In-Touch focuses on four pillars: job preparedness, social awareness, life skills, and entrepreneurship. Peter's work extends into families, where he believes true conflict resolution begins, helping parents and children break cycles of trauma.

Despite facing xenophobia as a Zimbabwean in South Africa, he continues to serve communities with humility and persistence. His organisation is now known for fostering positive masculinity, tackling GBV, and promoting climate justice—demonstrating how Khulisa's seed of support has grown into a powerful force for healing and empowerment.

LYDIA SONO: THE LYDIA SONO FOUNDATION

Lydia's connection with Khulisa spans more than 20 years. She began as a Youth Development Officer in Mpumalanga, where her empathy and leadership quickly stood out. As an openly LGBTQIA+ woman in deeply traditional communities, she endured stigma, violence, and rejection—including a brutal "corrective rape" attack that became a turning point in her activism. Supported and encouraged by Khulisa, Lydia transformed her pain into purpose, founding The Lydia Sono Foundation.



The Foundation champions LGBTQIA+ rights while serving as a lifeline for many. From its base in Schoemansdal, it provides a safe space for LGBTQIA+ youth, drives community dialogues on inclusion, partners with schools and the Department of Basic Education to protect learners' rights, and supports survivors of GBV.

Over the years, Lydia has also led road safety campaigns, coordinated COVID-19 relief efforts distributing thousands of masks, run donation drives, and created programmes that empower women and children. National recognition—including the Sunrise Woman Award, the Mail and Guardian Rural Development Award, and placement among South Africa's 100 Shining Stars—reflects her extraordinary impact.

Yet Lydia's vision remains rooted in her community: to build a multi-purpose recreational centre where all people, regardless of gender, sexuality, or background, can learn, grow, and belong.

LESEGO RICHARD TSHABALALA GET INFORMED! YOUTH DEVELOPMENT CENTRE

Lesego's journey demonstrates the lasting impact of mentorship. A qualified Social Auxiliary Worker with a strong dedication to restorative justice, he was guided by Khulisa to establish Get Informed YDC in 2013. Starting from a small initiative in Tembisa, Get Informed! has expanded into a thriving centre that now benefits over 3,000 individuals annually—and more than 21,000 since it began.



Its broad programmes include ECD practitioner training, youth leadership academies, women's empowerment projects, aftercare and nutrition support, school-based interventions, and small business incubation. With Khulisa's support, Lesego has strengthened his organisation through corporate mentorships, joint training programmes, and leadership development.

His belief is simple but powerful: when young people are equipped with skills, opportunities, and confidence, they not only transform their own futures but also uplift their communities. Today, Get Informed YDC is one of Tembisa's most vibrant centres of hope, opportunity, and empowerment.

OPINION PIECE: NGO DEREGISTRATION

A PATHWAY, NOT A PUNISHMENT: RETHINKING NGO DEREGISTRATION

SIPHO MNGUNI, KHULISA NGO QUALITY ASSURANCE SPECIALIST

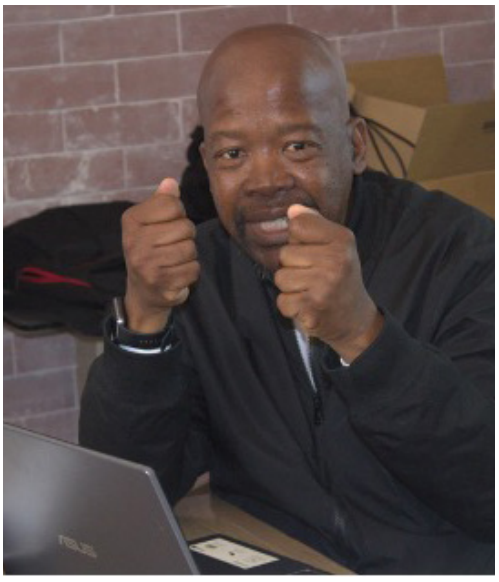
Sipho Mnguni still remembers the words of a community leader in the Northern Cape who runs a small after-school project: "We're not accountants—we just want to help our children learn."

Her organisation had been serving hot meals and tutoring dozens of learners for years, yet one notice from the Department of Social Development (DSD) placed everything at risk. The letter was clear: submit audited financials, update the constitution, prove board functionality—or face deregistration.

This is not an isolated story. By February 2025, more than 41,700 NGOs had received similar warnings. Already, over 6,200 had lost their registration. With deregistration comes the loss of tax exemption, donor funding, and credibility. For many community groups, this spells closure.

THE HUMAN SIDE OF COMPLIANCE

In South Africa, NGOs are often the first to respond where the state cannot—feeding schemes, GBV shelters, school support, counselling, community safety. But most of these organisations were started by ordinary people who saw a need and acted. Their expertise is compassion and service, not auditing or legal drafting.



As Sipho explains from his work at Khulisa Social Solutions:

- Financial records are often kept by volunteers using notebooks.
- Boards rarely meet formally, and minutes are seldom filed.
- Constitutions were written years ago and no longer meet current legal requirements.
- Staff turnover means compliance knowledge is lost and has to be rebuilt again and again.
- These are not failures of integrity. They are signs of capacity gaps.

FROM FEAR TO CONFIDENCE

Khulisa saw the writing on the wall: unless NGOs were supported, many would fold—not because they lacked heart, but because they lacked systems.

In response, the organisation established its **NGO Compliance Unit**. Instead of treating compliance as a hurdle, the unit reframes it as a journey:

- Helping NGOs update constitutions and register with SARS.
- Providing access to technology and office support.
- Training boards and managers on leadership and governance.
- Guiding NGOs through financial reporting and fundraising systems.
- The results have been transformative. Where NGOs once approached compliance with fear, they now begin to engage with confidence—able to focus on their mission while meeting requirements.

A COLLECTIVE EFFORT

Government, too, is recognising the urgency. In the Western Cape, the DSD's Institutional Capacity Building team runs mobile helpdesks, walk-in clinics, and online support systems, enabling thousands of NGOs to correct records and meet compliance obligations.

But government cannot do it alone. Corporates and donors must acknowledge that audits, admin staff, and compliance systems are not luxuries—they are essential to sustainability. And intermediaries like Khulisa must continue to serve as bridges, translating regulations into practical steps that grassroots leaders can follow.

Above all, NGOs themselves must commit to good governance. Transparency and accountability are not add-ons; they are the foundation for lasting impact.

LOOKING AHEAD

Sipho's vision is simple: a South Africa where NGOs thrive because they are supported, not sidelined. Where compliance is not a bureaucratic obstacle but a developmental pathway. Where collaboration ensures that organisations doing the hard work of feeding, protecting, and uplifting communities are not shut down for want of a signed board resolution.

Deregistration should never become a purge. It should be an opportunity for growth, equipping NGOs with the tools to serve their communities more effectively.

And so, the story continues—not of loss, but of possibility—if we choose to walk this journey together.

collaboration ensures that organisations doing the hard work of feeding, protecting, and uplifting communities are not shut down for want of a signed board resolution.

CASE STUDIES

REAL LIVES, REAL CHANGE, KHULISA'S JOURNEY OF EMPOWERMENT ACROSS SOUTH AFRICA

EMPOWERING LEARNERS, STRENGTHENING NGOS, BUILDING COHESION

WESTERN CAPE

2025: Building resilience and hope among Young learners in strand

In March 2025, Khulisa Social Solutions, in partnership with the Western Cape Department of Social Development, piloted the Special Crime Prevention Project at Selukhanyo Primary School, Strand. The initiative reached over 200 Grade 7 learners and tackled four urgent issues: bullying, gender-based violence (GBV), substance abuse, and youth crime. What made this intervention unique was its blend of learner-led creativity with real-time AI-enabled analysis, providing deep insights into the lived realities of young people.

Creative, evidence-driven engagement

Over the course of four days, learners engaged in role-playing, storytelling, drawing, and group presentations. Social workers and wellness counsellors facilitated sessions with the support of AI tools that analysed conversations and artworks, identifying emerging risks and guiding psychosocial support in real time. This combined approach brought together human interpretation and AI assistance, merging Participatory Action Research, the Social-Ecological Model, and Restorative Justice. The result was a process that encouraged ownership, empathy, and accountability.

Tackling GBV, substance abuse, crime and bullying

Learners created "Armor of Respect" shields and "Silent Tears" artworks, revealing the emotional toll of GBV but also their resilience. AI analysis confirmed themes of isolation yet highlighted hope. Substance abuse was tackled through the "Coolest School" Challenge, where students designed drug-free school environments with positive peer influence.

In sessions on youth crime, learners pointed to poverty, lack of parental guidance, and peer pressure, while also emphasising the role of supportive families and inclusive schools. Bullying and cyberbullying were addressed through posters, drama, and digital citizenship activities, reinforcing the role of bystanders and whole-school policies.



Learners' own solutions

Children proposed practical recommendations: school counselling and peer support, stronger parenting education, food security programmes, digital literacy training, and anti-bullying campaigns. These revealed their ability not only to describe problems but to design systemic solutions.

Impact and lessons

The programme enhanced learners' confidence, empathy, and resilience. Facilitators reported stronger peer support and safer classroom environments. While AI struggled with local dialects, human facilitators bridged gaps—underscoring the principle that technology should complement, not replace, human connection.

Looking forward

The Strand project demonstrated how creativity, dialogue, and technology can be harnessed to empower children as problem-solvers. It set a replicable blueprint for systemic, youth-led change in schools and communities. As one participant expressed: "We are not just learning to stop problems. We are learning to build a better future."

"We are not just learning to stop problems. We are learning to build a better future."





NORTHERN CAPE

2024–2025: Transforming grassroots NGOs into catalysts for lasting change

In 2024, Khulisa Social Solutions, in partnership with Knowledge Pele and the Peace Humansrus Trust, launched an NGO Capacitation Programme in Danielskuil and Postmasburg. The objective was to transform four fragile grassroots NGOs into sustainable, compliant, and innovative leaders of community change.

Building identity and community voice

For the first time, Kgatelopele Youth Development Forum (KYDF), Saving Lives Danielskuil (SLDK), Tsantsabane Skills Development Centre (TSD), and Blessed is the Hand that Gives gained professional logos, branding, and online platforms. Participatory Transect Walks enabled them to identify assets and design evidence-based strategies.

Strengthening the core

Mentoring introduced governance systems, cloud-based accounting, SARS registration, and structured board oversight. By the end of 2024, NGOs that once relied on volunteers and paper-based systems could manage budgets, write professional reports, and present themselves as credible partners.

Innovation, dialogue and social cohesion

Training in SIT and narrative therapy enabled NGOs to lead dialogue circles on GBV, unemployment, and youth disengagement. AI-assisted transcription simplified data collection and deepened community insights. NGOs moved from reactive service delivery to leadership in shaping long-term solutions.

Breaking barriers to funding and jobs

Between April 2025 and March 2026, the NGOs secured over R3.5 million in donor funding, including DGMT, Solar Mining Services, and Lesedi Solar Trust. They created 20+ jobs, providing dignity and income to local families.

Challenges and resilience

Funding delays, rising crime, and internal conflicts tested them, but refresher governance training and mediation restored confidence. These challenges became steppingstones to stronger, more resilient organisations.

Impact and looking ahead

By programme close, the NGOs were financially autonomous, operating from professional offices, and running evidence-based, community-led interventions. As one leader reflected: “We’ve gone from struggling to survive to being ready to grow.” Their transformation stands as a replicable model for grassroots empowerment in other provinces.

NORTH-WEST (RUSTENBURG)

2000–2025: Twenty-five years of community-led change in a mining town

In 2025, Khulisa Social Solutions celebrates 25 years of continuous impact in Rustenburg. What began as a youth development initiative in 2000 has grown into a systemic, multi-sectoral model addressing GBV, crime, unemployment, and inequality.

Early years: planting seeds of change (2000–2007)

Khulisa launched Make It Better (MIB) to build youth leadership and prevent crime. By 2004, diversion services expanded into correctional centres, introducing peer education on HIV/AIDS, drug awareness, and mediation—laying the foundation for prevention and rehabilitation pathways.

Building integrated models (2008–2019)

Over this period, diversion, trauma care, and school programmes expanded into an Integrated Community Model that united schools, NGOs, and government. Dialogue circles, martial arts, and restorative practices tackled root causes of dysfunction, while ECD and aftercare services strengthened family systems.

Tackling systemic dysfunction (2019–2021)

The Communities of Opportunity initiative addressed blockages such as unemployment and violence. During the COVID-19 pandemic, Khulisa pivoted to telecounselling, awareness campaigns, and household surveys, demonstrating agility in its crisis response.

Scaling innovation (2022–2025)

Khulisa sharpened its focus on livelihoods and coalitions. Initiatives like Garden in a Bucket, permaculture training, and entrepreneurship workshops built economic resilience. Between 2023 and March 2025, 25 SIT-led dialogue circles with 686 participants tackled GBV, unemployment, farmer challenges, and school safety—ensuring inclusive ownership of solutions.

Stories of transformation

Former offenders like Karabo and Moses now lead NGOs and hold stable jobs. Beneficiaries like Pindile established food security initiatives creating both nourishment and employment. These personal journeys embody Khulisa's ethos: with opportunity, every life can drive community change.

Collaboration and innovation

Partnerships with Sibanye, Investec, Netcare, and DSD enabled scale. Innovations in restorative justice, narrative therapy, and Systematic Inventive Mediation reinforced local ownership of solutions.

H.E.A.R.T

Looking ahead

The HEART Vision (Holistic Empowerment through Action, Resilience & Transformation) will build on CIM and SIT to strengthen NGO ecosystems, restorative justice, and livelihoods. Rustenburg's 25-year journey proves that empowered communities, when equipped with systems and support, can achieve lasting social cohesion.

A DAY IN THE LIFE AT KHULISA

SEEING OUR WORK THROUGH THE EYES OF OUR PEOPLE

For this year's annual report, we chose to break from tradition. Instead of presenting our work through statistics and regional summaries, we have selected a few staff members to share their personal stories.

These "Day in the Life" reflections are not formal reports – they are honest, often humorous, and deeply human accounts of the moments, challenges, and triumphs that shape daily life at Khulisa. Together, they capture the diversity of our organisation: from finance and governance to frontline social work, from driver logistics to project facilitation, from high-pressure donor compliance to the quiet joy of seeing someone's life take a positive turn. Through these stories, we catch a glimpse of the heartbeat of Khulisa – a vibrant ecosystem of people whose dedication extends far beyond their job descriptions.

They remind us of the unpredictable mix of urgency and laughter, the resilience that carries us through the toughest moments, and the shared commitment to our mission, regardless of role or location. By immersing readers in these lived realities, we seek to offer more than just an operational overview. We invite you to experience what it feels like to be part of Khulisa – to witness the adaptability, warmth, and values that define us.



SHARED SERVICES CENTRE

TAFADZWA MAGLAS
Head of Finance

Taf oversees financial planning, donor compliance, and NGO development support across all provinces. His day often starts at 3am, when the quiet allows him to tackle complex reporting before the office buzz begins. At the SSC he manages cash flows, SARS compliance, and donor audits, guiding his finance team through the "beautiful chaos" of a support hub. His role demands vigilance, as every cent must be accounted for. He finds joy in small moments, such as Alicia's hot lunches, but evenings can be lonely as he works late to ensure Khulisa's financial integrity. He jokes that he's married to spreadsheets – though it's a marriage that keeps Khulisa's programmes on solid ground.

AFRICA MONYAI
Community Coordinator

Africa supports projects and offices nationwide, coordinating logistics, training, AI tools and stakeholder engagement for over 500 staff and volunteers. His mornings begin with emails and preparations before heading out to travel, facilitate, or edit reports. The most unpredictable part? Working with Lesley Ann, whose constant stream of ideas keeps him on his toes (and sometimes on a plane). The toughest part is juggling unfamiliar assignments under tight deadlines, but they also encourage his growth. He thrives on road trips and puzzle-solving dinners with colleagues, where serious discussions blend easily with laughter. His role often extends into weekends, but he admits he secretly enjoys the adventure of never knowing what challenge tomorrow will bring.

NATASHA ROSSOW
Finance and Payroll Administrator

Natasha manages payroll and finance across all national offices. Her day is a whirlwind of emails, urgent payment requests, and cash advance needs as staff rush out the door. Alicia's coffee keeps her sane, while chats with Taf and Adri add comic relief to otherwise tense days. The hardest part is juggling mountains of correspondence with actual work, but she's famed for her lightning-fast replies – something Les always notices. During audit week she once almost signed off an email as "Kind retard." Thank goodness she caught it – though her colleagues will never let her live it down. It's a role of constant interruptions, but the family-like chaos is part of what makes her love it.

ADRI ACKERMAN
Company Administrator, Governance and Compliance Lead

Adri supports all offices with governance, HR, policies, compliance, and proposals. Working from home, her day begins early with coffee and blurs into hours of emails, board matters, and funding submissions. She often finds herself still in pyjamas by mid-afternoon unless a TEAMS meeting forces her to "look professional." She wears many hats: policy guardian, administrator, and fixer of all things unexpected. Challenges include feeling unseen, the "typist behind the screen," but she finds comfort in the occasional brainwave (or brain "glitch") shared with Lesley Ann that sends them both into fits of laughter. Adri may not always be visible, but she is the quiet anchor that keeps the organisation on course.

OBED ZULU
Driver & Logistics Support

Obed supports operations across six provinces, managing vehicles, deliveries, removals, and general assistance while interacting with over 150 colleagues and stakeholders. His philosophy is simple: "Never be bullied into silence. Believe in yourself." His days are a mix of logistics, problem-solving, and helping wherever needed. He finds joy in completing tasks and spending time with his family, although frustrations arise when he cannot fulfil his commitments. Equipment breakdowns and unpredictable hurdles keep him adaptable. He still laughs at the story of a colleague and a baboon that has become office legend. Dependable and good-humoured, Obed is proof that logistics is as much about heart as it is about horsepower.



REGIONS

MABANA MOYO
Chief Social Worker, Gauteng

Mabana oversees operations in Johannesburg, Tshwane, and the West Rand, with a team of 42 staff, volunteers, and students. She balances supervision, training, budgets, stakeholder partnerships, and handles complex casework. Her days are packed with meetings, staff support, and travel, but also with moments of pride – like securing programme accreditation or seeing staff grow professionally. She balances relationships with departments such as DSD and DOE while ensuring Khulisa maintains credibility through compliance and high standards. Challenges include last-minute requests and data losses, yet her team's problem-solving spirit keeps her motivated. "We laugh through the stress," she says, because humour is often the glue that holds the team together.

LUNGILE MADLALA
Principal Social Worker, eMalahleni

Lungile manages social work services across four municipalities, leading a team of five staff and an intern. Her mornings begin with lemon tea and reflection before diving into meetings, staff consultations, and departmental liaison. She works to balance complex cases with limited resources, ensuring quality without overburdening her team. Strong governance and DSD partnerships strengthen her region's capacity. Her joy lies in witnessing her team's focus and dedication, while her toughest challenge is managing rising demands with scarce resources. She quips that her office should install a revolving door for the constant stream of cases – but she wouldn't have it any other way.

HILDAH MODISE
Social Work Supervisor, Rustenburg

Hildah leads a team of four staff members, interns, and volunteers, overseeing programme delivery and stakeholder engagement. She views clients holistically, focusing on independence and hope. Her greatest joy is seeing smiles and positive change, while her toughest moments involve navigating disrespect and toxic environments. Mandela Day 2024 was a highlight, when her team served at an old-age home, embodying Ubuntu. She believes empathy, love, and assertiveness, under God's guidance, create a healthy workplace. GBV and domestic violence cases can be heartbreaking, but she says her growing love for the profession still surprises her. "Who knew stress and laughter could be such close companions?"

EVERMORE MADAMOMBE
Social Work Supervisor, Western Cape

Evermore oversees a regional team of 13 staff, supporting casework, compliance, training, and stakeholder engagement. Her days start with check-ins but often shift into crisis by 09:00. She travels between offices, guiding staff and sometimes intervening directly. Unexpected events, from heavy caseloads to office flooding, require flexibility, but laughter with colleagues helps balance the strain. She finds fulfilment in seeing clients progress – from school reintegration to family reunification – while limited resources remain the greatest obstacle. "Some days feel like juggling flaming torches," she jokes, "but at least my team keeps me laughing when I drop one."



JESSE LAITINEN

Manager: Strategic Partnerships

Jesse's mornings start with strong coffee and a check-in with her team. Some days bring wins – clients securing jobs or entering rehab – while others bring crises. Her role blends fundraising, project management, and sector collaboration with on-the-ground support for clients in gardens or markets. She collaborates with government agencies, NGOs, and local partners to enhance services for the homeless, while also addressing daily operational challenges. The days are intense but anchored by laughter and solidarity in the team. What keeps Jesse going is transformation – not only in clients' lives, but in shifting how society views and values them. "It's never boring," she grins, "and that's exactly why I love it."

CRAIG SETZIN

Social Auxiliary Worker, Rustenburg

Craig works with about 50 people daily through psychosocial support, workshops, aftercare, and dialogue circles. He runs awareness drives, parental sessions, and even puppet programmes to reach diverse audiences. His mornings begin with planning and coordinating stakeholders across schools, NGOs, and departments. Challenges like poor communication test his patience, but he thrives in fieldwork where change is visible. The highlight is seeing young people regain confidence or families rediscover hope. He admits the puppet shows are his favourite: "Who says social work can't include a little comedy?"

KIMBERLEY MAIDA

Project Lead, Limpopo

Kimberley supports SSC and regional operations with training, capacity development, stakeholder engagement, and CIM rollout. Work-from-home days begin with coffee and emails, while field days are full of logistics, facilitation, and participant engagement. WhatsApp has become a lifeline for coordination. She loves the "aha" moments during training and facilitation, though reporting season brings the toughest pressure. The unpredictability of people – their personalities and stories – makes each day unique. What she wishes people knew: her work is not only about technical skills but about building trust, adapting, and keeping humour alive. "If you can't laugh at the chaos," she says, "you'll never survive the field."

HONOURING KHULISA LONG SERVING STAFF MEMBERS

ALICIA NDLOVU: 17 YEARS SERVICE

A JOURNEY OF GROWTH: ALICIA NDLOVU'S DECADE OF DEDICATION AT KHULISA



When Alicia Ndlovu walked into Khulisa for the first time, she was nervous—but immediately struck by the warmth and respect she received. "Even though I started as a cleaner, they treated me with kindness. I felt like I was part of something bigger," she recalls. That moment marked the beginning of a remarkable journey that has spanned many years and roles.

Over time, Alicia transitioned from housekeeping to becoming a key part of Khulisa's administrative team. Her determination, curiosity, and willingness to help laid the foundation for her growth. "I didn't know how to use a computer or send an email," she says, "but I was always open to learning. I had people who believed in me—and that made all the difference."

The turning point came when she was promoted to receptionist, a role that tested her confidence but revealed her capability. "I was nervous, but I did it. That's when I realised I could do more than I believed," she says proudly. Today, Alicia confidently handles a wide range of administrative tasks—from HR support to research assistance—making her an invaluable team member.

For Alicia, leadership at Khulisa is not about giving orders; it's about giving people opportunities and helping them grow. She embodies this philosophy in her own journey and encourages others starting in entry-level roles to be open, ask questions, and give their best.

Reflecting on her long service, Alicia believes her experience reflects the true values of Khulisa. "My journey shows that Khulisa is a place where growth is possible. They believe in people. If you're willing to learn and work hard, they'll give you a chance."

Alicia's story is a testament to what's possible when support meets determination. Her loyalty, growth, and quiet strength have left an enduring mark on the organisation—and serve as an inspiration to those just beginning their own journeys at Khulisa.

MAGAUTA SERETSANE: 17 YEARS SERVICE

MAGAUTA SERETSANE: IMPACTFUL LEADER IN VICTIM SUPPORT



Magauta Seretsane has been with Khulisa Social Solutions for nearly 17 years, a journey that has deeply shaped her both personally and professionally. Starting with a background at POWA, her passion for supporting survivors of gender-based violence (GBV) led her to Khulisa, where she has grown into a resilient, empathetic, and impactful leader in the field of victim support.

Throughout her long-standing service at Khulisa, Magauta has engaged directly with diverse communities, gaining valuable insight into social dynamics and community needs.

Her exposure to trauma—particularly among women and youth—has strengthened her emotional resilience and deepened her commitment to advocacy and healing. One of the most traumatic moments she recalled was supporting a young survivor of abuse, which she processed through supervision, peer support, and mindfulness practices.

Magauta highlighted several persistent barriers facing GBV survivors, including social stigma, cultural silence, and lack of access to comprehensive services. To address these, she champions holistic solutions: integrated support systems offering legal, emotional, and economic empowerment; peer support groups; and the urgent need for safe shelters.

She believes that systemic change must include:

- Early community education to challenge harmful norms,
- Stronger survivor support networks, and
- Actively engaging men and boys in redefining masculinity and preventing violence.

Magauta's message to young professionals in the field is clear: prioritise self-care, seek supervision, and stay connected with peers. Her enduring service at Khulisa reflects her belief in the transformative power of empathy, collective action, and sustained community engagement.

ROBERT MOLEFE: 17 YEARS SERVICE

A STORY OF RESILIENCE AND TRANSFORMATION: ROBERT MOLEFE

Robert Molefe's journey with Khulisa Social Solutions is a story of resilience, transformation, and longstanding commitment that spans nearly two decades. For 17 years, he has walked alongside communities, bringing hope and healing to some of South Africa's most vulnerable individuals.

Robert's path began unexpectedly. Initially seeking escape from a difficult personal history, he joined Khulisa through the My Path programme, where he discovered new tools of discipline, resilience, and self-reliance. What started as a personal turning point soon evolved into a lifelong vocation. Robert found his purpose in supporting survivors of abuse, mentoring young men, and helping families find ways to heal fractured relationships.

Over the years, his service has stretched across provinces including Limpopo, Mpumalanga, the Free State, and the Eastern Cape. Despite cultural and social differences, Robert built common threads of trust, always guided by the belief that dignity, justice, and second chances can redefine lives. His facilitation of social entrepreneurship in schools, peer support groups, and leadership training has inspired hundreds of young people to choose growth over despair.



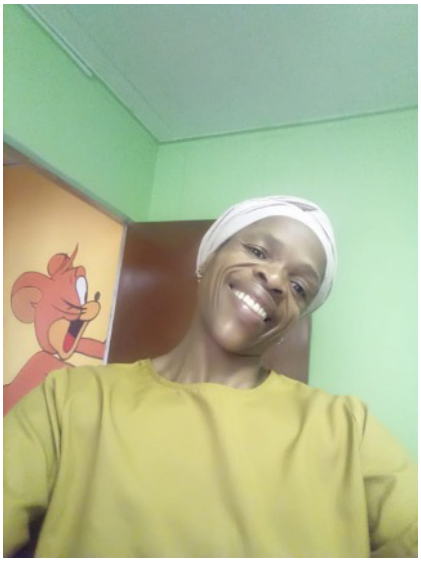
Among his most memorable experiences was supporting a young survivor of abuse through her trauma journey. With patience and compassion, Robert guided her from crisis to resilience, demonstrating his gift for combining professional expertise with genuine empathy.

Robert's 17 years of dedicated service embody Khulisa's vision of restorative justice and community-driven change. His work illustrates how transformation is not an abstract idea but a lived experience that reshapes both individuals and communities.

As Khulisa reflects on its 25-year legacy, Robert's contribution stands as a testament to what is possible when lived experience is harnessed for healing. His story reminds us that lasting change is achieved not only through programmes but through the consistent presence of people committed to building stronger, more compassionate communities.

"(Robert's) work illustrates how transformation is not an abstract idea but a lived experience that reshapes both individuals and communities."

BETTY MAZIBUKO: 16 YEARS SERVICE



"WE SHOW UP BECAUSE WE CARE": BETTY MAZIBUKO'S COURAGE IN SOPHIATOWN

For over a decade, Betty Mazibuko has been a pillar of strength in one of Johannesburg's most violent and underserved communities—Sophiatown. As a long-serving member of Khulisa Social Solutions, Betty has dedicated her life to walking alongside individuals and families navigating the harsh realities of gangsterism, drugs, and generational trauma.

Working in a place where gunshots echo daily and threats are constant, Betty admits, "The fear is always there—but we can't stop. Some communities need us." Despite a past incident where she was directly threatened by a drug-affected client, Betty continues to show up—driven by passion and a deep belief in the power of transformation.

She has witnessed how poverty and unemployment fuel cycles of gangsterism. "People join gangs to survive. Revenge, grudges, and violence are passed down like inheritance," she explains. Families carry immense emotional pressure in silence, fractured by pain that goes back generations. "There's no love here. People don't want to forgive, and that hatred eats away at the whole community."

Yet amid the despair, stories of hope remind Betty why her work matters. She speaks with pride about a young mother who once battled addiction but is now helping others recover, thanks to support from Khulisa's centre. "She changed. She's proof that people can rise again."

Betty acknowledges the personal toll of this work—long days, emotional exhaustion, and confronting deeply traumatic stories. But through regular supervision, the support of her team, and her own spiritual strength, she endures. "I don't carry it alone. We have one mission—to save this community."

Her message to government and donors is clear: "We're doing what we can, but it's not enough. We need shelters. We need short-term job opportunities for those we help, so they don't return to the same hopelessness."

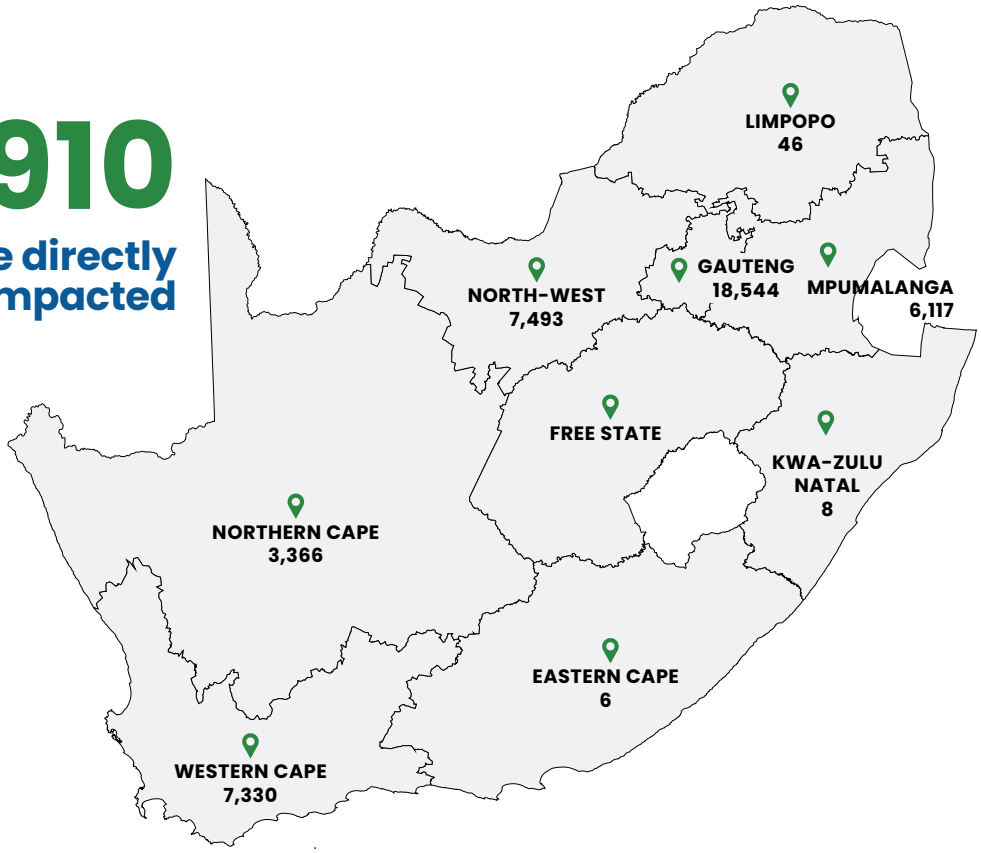
With quiet courage and unwavering commitment, Betty Mazibuko is not just serving a community—she is helping to rebuild it, one person, one conversation, and one act of compassion at a time.

"I don't carry it alone. We have one mission — to save this community."

GEOGRAPHIC FOOTPRINT

KHULISA SOCIAL SOLUTION'S IMPACT ACROSS SOUTH AFRICA BETWEEN APRIL 2024 TO MARCH 2025

42,910
people directly impacted



Summary of direct beneficiaries: 2024 - 2025

Province	
Gauteng, incl. National and SSC	**18,544**
North-West	**7,493**
Mpumalanga	**6,117**
Western Cape (Incl. Streetscapes)	**7,330**
Eastern Cape	**6**
Northern Cape	**3,366**
Kwa-Zulu Natal	**8**
Limpopo	**46**
TOTAL	**42,910**



FINANCIAL OVERVIEW

The below numbers were taken from the full audited statements presented at the Annual General Meeting, copies of which are available from Khulisa Social Solutions: tafadzwa@khulisa.org.za

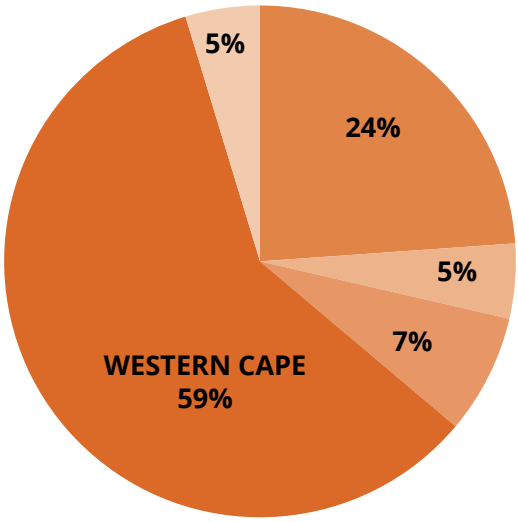
Khulisa Social Solutions NPC

(Registration number: 1998/001994/08)
Annual Financial Statements for the year ended 31 March 2025

Statement of Financial Position as at 31 March 2025

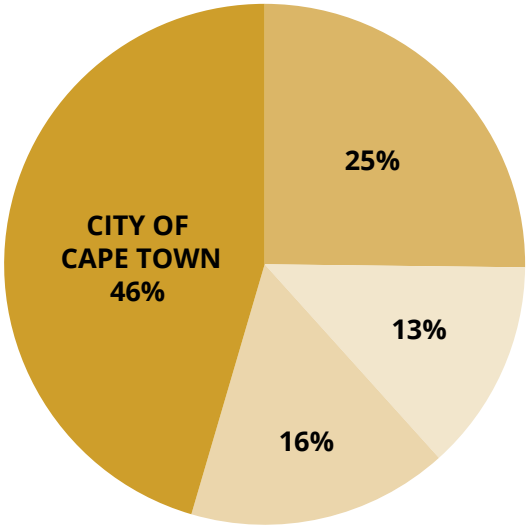
	Note(s)	2025 R	2024 R
ASSETS			
Non-Current Assets			
Property, plant and equipment	2	905 717	903 514
CURRENT ASSETS			
Receivables	3	377 191	741 968
Prepayments	4	261 932	971 073
Cash and cash equivalents	5	3 933 039	5 785 238
		4 572 162	**7 498 279**
Total Assets		**5 477 879**	**8 401 793**
EQUITY AND LIABILITIES			
Equity			
Retained income		124 534	45 356
LIABILITIES			
Current Liabilities			
Payables	6	1 171 363	1 056 295
Grants received in advance	7	4 092 282	7 167 142
Provisions	8	89 700	133 000
		5 353 345	**8 356 437**
Total Equity and Liabilities		**5 477 879**	**8 401 793**

FUNDING OVERVIEW



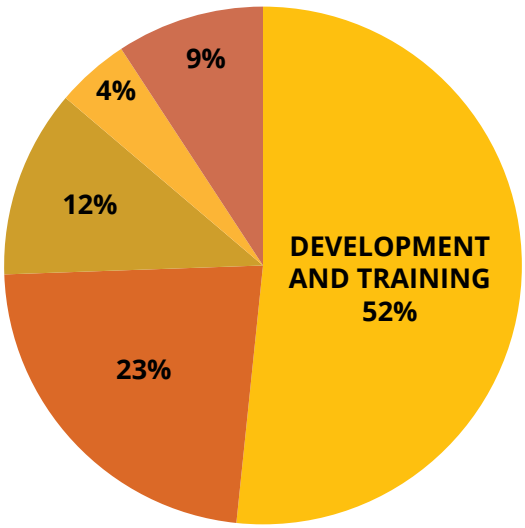
Funding by Province 2024 - 2025

- Western Cape **59%**
- Gauteng **24%**
- Mpumalanga **7%**
- North-West **5%**
- Northern Cape **5%**



Funding by Funder 2024 - 2025

- City of Cape Town **46%**
- Government Funding **25%**
- Foreign **16%**
- Private **13%**



Funding by Programme 2024 - 2025

- Development and Training **52%**
- Diversion **23%**
- NGO Capacitation **12%**
- Victim Empowerment **4%**
- Court Diversion **9%**

OUR DONORS & PARTNERS

SUSTAINING IMPACT AND ENABLING CHANGE

Khulisa's work would not be possible without the generosity and commitment of our donors and partners. Their financial contributions, in-kind support, and shared vision have enabled us to reach vulnerable communities, strengthen NGOs, and sustain meaningful impact across South Africa.

HEAD OFFICE

Channel 4 UK
First Rand Bank
Investec
Khulisa UK
David Gras (Kliptown Chess Project)
Peace Humansrust Trust
Momentum
Nedbank Group
Pure Madi
SMEC SA
The Pantry
Tshikululu Investments
EDS Chemicals (Pty) Ltd
Genisis Steel
Halowenthal
Investec Private Partners
KAEFER Energy Projects (Pty) Ltd
Medicare Hospital Rustenburg
Surtech Solutions
Woolworths
Sibanye SRMCDT
Chaba, Makana, Grassridge Windfarms
Ponahalo De Beers Trust (PDT)

GAUTENG REGIONAL

Department of Social Development (DSD)
Ekangala
Hammanskraal
Johannesburg / Roodepoort
Victim Empowerment Centres
West Rand

MPUMALANGA REGIONAL

Department of Social Development (DSD)
eMalahleni

WESTERN CAPE REGIONAL

Apex Hi Charitable Trust
Central City Improvement District
City of Cape Town
Comic Relief
Department of Social Development (DSD) Western Cape
Fenix African and Middle East (FAME)
ViiV Healthcare UK Limited - Momentum

STREETSCAPES

Central Methodist Mission
Christine Thomas
Christo Steyn
Frost & Norman
Heritage Tours
Kruiskerk Streetscapes
Stefan Ferreira
Steve and Theresa Truslow
Suzy Brokenshaw

KHULISA'S COMMITMENT TO ESG EXCELLENCE

ESG STATEMENT

At Khulisa Social Solutions, sustainability, accountability, and ethical leadership are at the heart of our operations. We align our work with global Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) standards to ensure that our impact extends beyond immediate interventions to building a resilient and inclusive future.

ENVIRONMENTAL (E)

We recognise that social wellbeing and environmental sustainability are inseparable. Through our programmes, we:

- Promote sustainable livelihoods through initiatives such as community gardens, recycling programs, and waste-to-income projects.
- Encourage eco-friendly practices in schools and communities to foster a culture of environmental responsibility.
- Reduce our operational footprint by digitising data, limiting unnecessary travel, and leveraging technology to connect teams and partners.

SOCIAL (S)

Khulisa's work is grounded in strengthening the social fabric of South Africa:

- We drive social cohesion through dialogue circles, restorative justice, and NGO capacity building.
- We actively support equity and inclusion, prioritising women, youth, persons with disabilities, and marginalised groups.
- We invest in staff wellbeing and development, recognising that our people are central to achieving sustainable change.

GOVERNANCE (G)

Strong governance safeguards our credibility and sustainability:

- As a Level One BBBEE-registered NPO and certified 18A tax-exempt organisation, we maintain the highest levels of compliance and accountability.
- Our Finance and Compliance Unit provides governance, financial, and reporting training to grassroots NGOs, building sector-wide resilience.
- We are committed to transparent reporting and ethical management, ensuring accountability to our beneficiaries, donors, and partners.

GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

OVERVIEW OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS



IAN MANN
Non-Executive Chairman

Ian brings his extensive expertise as the Founder and Managing Director of Gateways Business Consultants, a respected consultancy specialising in leadership and strategy for large and medium-sized businesses across 14 countries.



KHOMI CIMUS (KC) MAKHUBELE:
Deputy chairman

KC is a results-oriented business leader with a proven track record in strategic overall business management, marketing and human capital development, demonstrating a strong entrepreneurial spirit.



LESLEY ANN VAN SELM:
Founder & Managing Director

Lesley Ann launched her career by establishing a marketing company at the age of 24 in 1979. She has dedicated herself to uplifting marginalized communities, and her journey led to the inception of Khulisa in 1997, where she initiated a storytelling programmefor juvenile offenders using African stories to instil cultural pride.



LYNNE ROSS:
Director

Lynne is a successful entrepreneur known for her extensive experience across various business and discipline areas. She founded Idea Alive SA (IASA) in 2014, specializing in executive, business, and life coaching, addressing business strategy, leadership, communication, goal achievement, stress management and personal well-being.



VIMBAI MACHEKA:
Director

Vimbai Macheka is a Chartered Accountant with expertise in financial management and accounting, particularly in establishing controls, governance, internal auditing and risk management. She played a significant role in the SAICA National Building Project, aligning financial management processes with PFMA and National Treasury Regulations, and is passionate about empowering women and youth.



LUTFIYA FAJANDER:
Director

Lutfiya is a Finance Executive with vast experience spanning multiple industries, including retail, distribution, financial services and infrastructure management.



MOTHATHE MDLELENI:
Director

Mothathe is a dynamic and globally minded professional with strong technical skills, excellent interpersonal abilities and adaptability.

She excels in independent work, strategic thinking, effective presentations, and solution development to achieve organisational goals.



ANELE MOTHA:
Director

Anele is a mid-level public relations professional recognised for her expertise in content development for B2B and B2C markets, exceptional media relations skills and adeptness in social media management.

She boasts strong relationships with media, cultural insights, and a track record of influencer engagement in B2C campaigns for premium and luxury brands.

A NATIONAL CALL TO ACTION

ADDRESSING SYSTEMIC CHALLENGES

Over the past five years, Khulisa Socal Solutions has engaged **50,000 children** across South Africa in one of the largest youth research initiatives of its kind.

Their voices have painted a stark picture of the systemic challenges undermining our nation's future:

60% of children experience multidimensional poverty

Over 60% of children experience multidimensional poverty, lacking access to food, healthcare, education, and safe environments.

51% children live below poverty line

51% of children live below the poverty line, and 23% face severe child food poverty, leaving them vulnerable to malnutrition and developmental harm.

<50% less than hald of learners complete matric

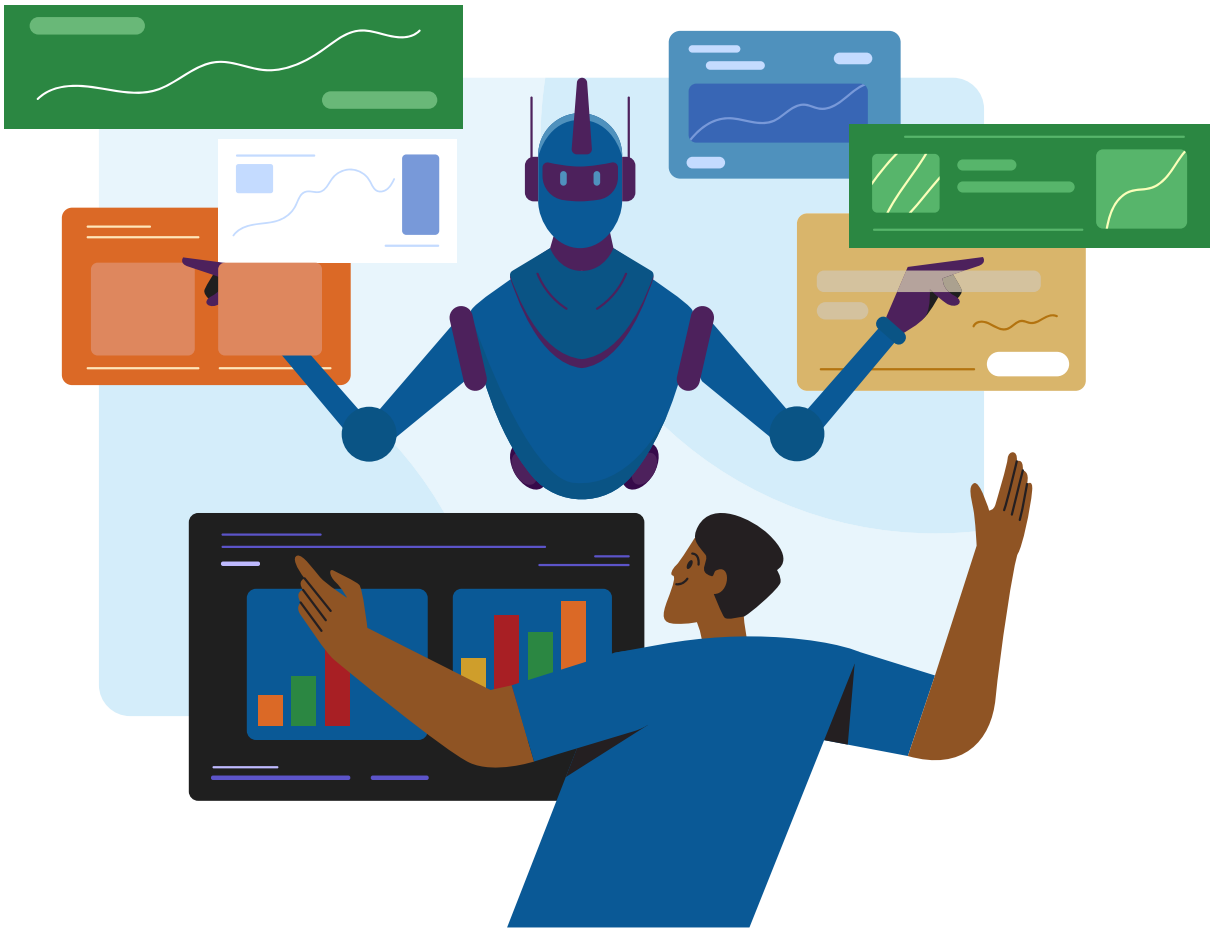
School dropouts remain high: less than half of learners complete matric, often due to trauma, hunger, or unsafe schools.

1 in 3 of women experience intimate partner violence

Gender-based violence and trauma are pervasive, with 1 in 3 women experiencing intimate partner violence, and many children reporting abuse.

<2 psychologists per 100 000 residents

Mental health services are critically scarce, with fewer than two psychologists per 100,000 residents nation-wide.



These findings confirm what Khulisa has long recognised: no single issue exists in isolation. Poverty fuels trauma, trauma drives school dropouts, and exclusion perpetuates crime and inequality. To break these cycles, we need systemic solutions that cut across silos.

THE ROLE OF CIM

Khulisa's Collaborative Implementation Model (CIM) turns lived experiences into practical, measurable interventions. By combining dialogue circles, narrative therapy, SIT innovation, and AI-enabled monitoring, CIM transforms fragmented responses into whole-community action plans aligned with municipal and national development priorities. It is a proven pathway for addressing systemic barriers and fostering lasting social cohesion.

HOW YOU CAN HELP

We urgently seek support to expand this work nationally:

1. **Financial Contributions** – to fund trauma-informed school programmes, youth leadership development, NGO capacity-building, and community-based interventions.
2. **In-Kind Donations** – including food, school supplies, sanitary products, IT equipment, and safe-space infrastructure.

Every rand and every donation is tracked transparently through our AI-enabled systems, ensuring a measurable return on investment.

CONTACT INFORMATION

AND HOW TO GET INVOLVED

Khulisa has been a registered non-profit company since 1998, registration number 98/001994/08. We have been approved for purposes of Section 18A (1) (a) of the Income Tax Act and donations made to the organization will be tax deductible in the hands of the donors. We are a Level 1 BBBEE organization with 100% black beneficiaries.

SHARED SERVICES CENTRE

105 Oxford Road, Saxonwold, 2193, Gauteng

Managing Director	Lesley Ann van Selm
Registration No	98/001994/08
Finance	Tafadzwa Maglas
VAT No	4150197192
Funding/Partnerships	Lesley Ann van Selm
PBO No	930010654
Office Liaison	Alicia Ndlovu

FUNDING CONTACT

Lesley Ann van Selm: lesleyann@khulsa.org.za

DONATIONS CONTACT

Natasha Rossow: natasha@khulisa.org.za





Regional Offices

KHULISA GAUTENG

Meet us 23 Amelia Street, Roodepoort
Contact Person Mabana Moyo
Contact us mabana@khulisa.org.za | 072 071 3551

KHULISA MPUMALANGA

Meet us Office No. G12 and G13, Smuts Park Building
Cnr Northey Street & Smuts Avenue, Emalahleni
Contact Person Lungile Madlala
Contact us lungilem@khulisa.org.za | 073 588 6062

KHULISA LIMPOPO

Meet us Block G, Stand 1335 next to Moshate, Taaibosch Area, Taaibosch.
Contact Person
Contact us

KHULISA NORTH-WEST

Meet us 7 Zendeling Street, Rustenburg
Contact Person Hildah Modise
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